Norah Porter

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SUMMARY

Dedicated QA tester with 11 years of professional QA experience, including over 10 shipped games, plus several apps and websites. Experienced in a wide range of QA practices across many platforms, interfaces, and products. Expert in writing and maintaining comprehensive testplans and design documents. Background in Geosciences and GIS Analysis, with 3 years of Python and Lua.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Cyan (Mead, WA)
Quality Assurance Tester (July 2015 - Current)

- Tested and launched over 10 puzzle adventure games, including the *Myst* and *Riven* remakes, using both testplans and exploratory testing, across multiple platforms such as PC, Mac, iOS, Meta VR, and every major console.
- Created and maintained comprehensive testplans covering feature releases, regression testing, golden path playthroughs, persistence, localization, and TRCs for Playstation, Xbox, Nintendo, and Meta Quest VR.
- Logged, prioritized, reproduced, and tracked issues in Jira and Mantis while communicating findings across development disciplines.
- Delegated and scheduled daily tasks for a small QA team during leadership absences.
- Regularly captured performance analytics and optimization files, using Excel for analysis.
- Interfaced directly with Art and Programming teams to fix issues quickly, as well as learn about underlying systems to better understand, categorize, and assign later issues.
- Cooperated with outside development teams for 3 Cyan Ventures publishing releases, including acclaimed *The Last Clockwinder* for Quest VR.
- Edited and proofread FAQs, social media posts, and other written content.

Gameplay Designer (Jan 2023 - Jan 2025)

- Designed puzzles and narrative beats for 2 unannounced puzzle adventure projects in a small team.
- Lead gameplay design on the Rime update for Myst, including creating and fleshing out unique puzzles and puzzle devices.
- Created and maintained a dense branching dialogue flowchart for use in both development of a prototype and at an acting/mocap session, including over 100 nodes and several entry and exit points, as well as implemented this in UE5 using an in-house dialogue tool.
- Rapidly prototyped game concepts and mechanics in UE5 using Blueprints.
- Prepared and maintained detailed documentation for the broader development team from the results of design meetings, for use in technical implementations.
- Presented design documents, from fresh game ideas to puzzles and gameplay, including detailed design needs for both Art and Programming teams.

EDUCATION

University of Washington (Seattle, WA)
B.Sc., Earth and Space Sciences - Physics

- Graduated Aug 2017.
- Minor in Mathematics.

SKILLS

UE4, UE5, Gamemaker, Godot; Lua, UE Blueprints, Python, C++, R; Mantis, Jira; Microsoft Word, Excel, Powerpoint; FL Studio; Miro; ArcGIS; Adobe Photoshop, Paint.net, Procreate; proofreading and editing; technical writing.